

## Lesson 11

# Handling Workplace Negotiations



## Warm-Up

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1. What are some common reasons why employees negotiate?
2. What are some common topics in workplace negotiations?
3. How important are negotiation skills in the workplace?



## Role-Play

**Scenario:** *Two colleagues are talking about their recent job promotions. Read and study the words in bold.*

**Mitch:** Hey, Johnny! How did your negotiation with HR go regarding your job promotion?

**Johnny:** Oh, it was quite a process. I **had to bargain** a lot to get them to see my point of view.

**Mitch:** Really? What did you propose?

**Johnny:** **I proposed a new role** that would align better with my skills and experience.

**Mitch:** That sounds intense. Did you have to **compromise on anything**?

**Johnny:** Yes, I had to compromise on the salary a bit. But in the end, we **struck a deal** that included better benefits.

**Mitch:** That's great! It sounds like you managed to get a fair deal. I had a similar experience last year. It took a while to **find common ground**, but once we did, the compromise was worth it.

**Johnny:** Absolutely. It's all about **finding that balance** and making sure both sides feel like they've won something.

### Role-play Analysis

Read the statement and choose which one is True or False

- |                                                                    |               |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| 1. Jamie had to bargain with HR to support his proposal.           | True or False |
| 2. Jamie proposed a role that matched his skills and experience.   | True or False |
| 3. Jamie accepted the offer without any compromise.                | True or False |
| 4. Mitch also had to negotiate his promotion in the past.          | True or False |
| 5. Both believe finding common ground is important in negotiation. | True or False |

## Discussion

1. What negotiation strategies did Jamie use in the conversation?
2. Have you ever negotiated for something at work? What was the result?
3. Why is it important to strike a deal that benefits both sides?
4. What are some expressions you can use when proposing an idea in a negotiation?
5. What should you prepare before a salary or promotion negotiation?



## Key Phrases

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### EFFECTIVE OPENING STATEMENTS

1. When you negotiate to a proposal – you can **express your agreement** by saying

- ✓ **Would you be able to** + [ V ] - your proposal
- ✓ **Would you consider** + [ V + ing ] your proposal

**Example:**

- ✓ **Would you be able to review** my annual evaluation with a 10% increase?
- ✓ **Would you consider evaluating** my job performance for a 10% increase?

2. When you negotiate to a proposal – you can **express your disagreement** by saying

- ✓ **That's not quite what I had in mind** + your proposal
- ✓ **Let's find a fair solution** + your proposal

**Example:**

- ✓ That's not quite what I had in mind, and I feel like you can make an increase from 5% to 10%.
- ✓ Let's find a fair solution and compromise on 10% as the best number.



## Pronunciation

Practice pronouncing the following words.

- **Negotiate** /ni'gəʊʃiət/
- **Compromise** /'kɒmprəmaɪz/
- **Deal** /di:l/
- **Proposal** /prə'pəʊzl/



## Practice

Match the expressions with their correct functions

| Expression                             | Function                 |
|----------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| 1. <i>I see your point, but...</i>     | A. Problem-solving       |
| 2. <i>Can we find a middle ground?</i> | B. Agreeing              |
| 3. <i>How about we...?</i>             | C. Offering alternatives |
| 4. <i>That works for me.</i>           | D. Polite refusal        |
| 5. <i>I'm afraid that won't work.</i>  | E. Suggest compromise    |
| 6. <i>Let's look at the options.</i>   | F. Polite disagreement   |
| 7. <i>We could consider...</i>         | G. Make a suggestion     |





## Production

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### MINI CASE STUDY:

#### Instructions:

- **Work in pairs.** One student will be **Person A**, and the other will be **Person B**.
- **Read your role carefully** and think about your needs and priorities.
- **Take turns speaking.** Use polite and clear negotiation phrases you have learned (e.g., *"Can we find a middle ground?"*, *"What if..."*, *"I'm afraid that won't work..."*, *"That works for me."*).
- **Listen actively** to your partner. Show understanding even if you don't agree.
- **Try to reach a fair solution** that works for both people.
- When you finish, **switch roles** and try again with new ideas or different phrasing.

### SCENARIOS:

#### Scenario 1: Shift Swap

**A:** You want to take Friday off for a family event.

**B:** You have a doctor's appointment that day.

→ Discuss and try to find a solution.

#### ***Example ideas to include:***

"Can we find a middle ground?"

"What if I cover your shift next Monday instead?"

## Scenario 2: Team Task

**A:** You're asked to lead a project, but you already have too much work.

**B:** You think A should do it because they have more experience.

→ Try to agree on who should lead, or how to divide the task.

### ***Helpful phrases:***

"I see your point, but..."

"We could split the work this way..."

## Scenario 3: Working from Home

**A:** You want to work from home two days a week.

**B:** Your manager is not sure it's a good idea.

→ Talk about the pros and cons and suggest a compromise.

### ***Useful ideas:***

"Let's look at the options."

"How about we try it for two weeks?"

## Scenario 4: Rescheduling a Meeting

**A:** You're asked to join a meeting at 5:30 p.m., but you can't.

**B:** You think it's important and don't want to change the time.

→ Try to agree on a new time.

### ***Useful ideas:***

"Let's look at the options:..."

## Scenario 5: Training Opportunity

**A:** You are invited to attend a training abroad, but you have deadlines.

**B:** You want to go too, but can't both go.

→ Negotiate who should attend and suggest solutions.

### Useful ideas:

"We could consider..."

"How about we flip a coin, or ask the manager for advice?"

"That works for me if..."

### Tips for Speaking:

- Use at least 3 of the phrases from the lesson.
- Speak naturally and be polite.
- Don't forget to make suggestions and try to compromise.